

Rafael M. Rubião

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EDUCATION

PhD Global Economics and Management, **University of California, Los Angeles**, 2023-Present
MSc Economics *with Distinction*, **University College London**, 2019
BSc Economics, Universidade Federal de Minas Gerais, 2017

EMPLOYMENT

2021-23 Inter-American Development Bank, Department of Research – Research Fellow
Principal Investigator: Juan Pablo Chauvin
2020-21 World Bank, Poverty and Equity Global Practice – Consultant
Task Team Leaders: Gabriel Lara Ibarra, Liliana D Sousa
2015-17 Development Bank of Minas Gerais, Research and Strategy Departments – Intern

GRANTS, AWARDS AND FELLOWSHIPS

2018 Chevening Awards Scholarship, UCL/U.K. Foreign & Commonwealth Office
2018 ABDE-IDB Selected Papers Prize, Brazilian Association for Economic Development
2014 Young Researcher Scholarship, CNPQ/UFMG

RESEARCH

Working Papers

2026 "Is Money Overrated? Misperceived Satisfaction from Income" (with Ricardo Perez-Truglia)
NBER Working Paper No. 35423
2026 "The Undercounting of Births to Child Mothers" (with Juan Pablo Chauvin and Miguel Ángel Talamas Marcos)
SSRN Working Paper – Submitted

Select Work in Progress

"Human Capital and Political Capital" (with Julian Martinez-Correa and Valdemar Pinho Neto)

Policy and Other Writings

2021 Rubião, R. M.; Lara Ibarra, G.; and Fleury, E. Indirect Tax Incidence in Brazil : Assessing the Distributional Effects of Potential Tax Reforms. *Policy Research Working Paper*; No 9891; World Bank, Washington, DC.
2020 Rubião, R. M.; Sousa, L.; and Cereda, F. COVID-19, Labor Market Shocks, and Poverty in Brazil: A Microsimulation Analysis. Policy Note. Poverty and Equity GP, World Bank, Washington, DC.
2018 Rubião, R. M. Bancos de Desenvolvimento em questão: o impacto do ocaso dos fundos estaduais no "D" do BDMG. In: Prêmio ABDE-BID. Associação Brasileira de Desenvolvimento. ABDE Editorial, Rio de Janeiro, 2018. p. 99-126.
2017 Rubião, R. M. A short but deep dive into the economics of arts: Art Entrepreneurs in a Peripheral Market. *Artivate: A Journal of Entrepreneurship in the Arts*, Arizona State University, 7(2), 3-26.

Conference presentations

2016 19th International Conference of the Association for Cultural Economics International ACEI (Spain)

REFERENCES

Prof. Ricardo Perez-Truglia – University of California, Los Angeles – Contact: ricardo.truglia@anderson.ucla.edu
Prof. Natalie Bau – University of California, Los Angeles – Contact: nbau@g.ucla.edu
Prof. Clémence Tricaud – University of California, Los Angeles – Contact: clemence.tricaud@anderson.ucla.edu

SKILLS

Code Stata, Python, R, Git, LaTeX
Idiom Portuguese (native), English, French, Spanish (fluent)
Other GRE: Q170(96pctl)/V166(97pctl) | TOEFL: 113 | Real Analysis (UCSC): A+ (2nd out of 46)

Updated July 2026